Truth and ReconciliACTION: A Collective Independence

There comes a moment in a HUMAN LIFE…
when survival is no longer enough.

When fitting in, performing, pleasing, achieving—
no longer fills the quiet ache inside.

For many of us, that moment comes after years… even decades…
of trying to be who the world told us to be.

I know this… because I lived it.

I was raised to be perfect.
To be good.
To be agreeable.
To be strong on the outside…
and silent on the inside.

And for a long time, I believed that was success.

But it wasn't success.
It was disconnection.

Disconnection from my VOICE.
From my TRUTH.
From my WORTH.

And part of my TRUTH… is not easy to say out loud.

My grandfather was part of Nazi Germany.
I come from a lineage shaped by white supremacy.

And today… I stand here as a settler on this land—
living on Treaty 7 territory.

The traditional lands of the Blackfoot Confederacy,
the Tsuut'ina Nation,
and the Stoney Nakoda Nations.

That is not something I carry with shame—
but it is something I carry with RESPONSIBILITY.

Because the past does not disappear…
it echoes.

In what we are taught.
In what we are told not to question.
In the ways we learn to stay silent… or stay small… or stay in line.

And like so many people—
I carried that conditioning into adulthood…
into my relationships…
into my health.

Until one day in the recent past, my body reached its limit, and I was diagnosed with breast cancer, a turning point that called me into deep and ongoing healing and recovery.

Healing didn't begin when everything became easy.
Healing began when I became HONEST.

HONEST about the pain.
HONEST about the patterns.
HONEST about the ways I had abandoned myself…
just to belong.

And slowly, something changed.

I stopped trying to be perfect—
and started choosing to be AUTHENTIC and REAL.

I choose GRATITUDE… even when it was hard.
I choose JOY… even when the world feels heavy.
I choose BOUNDARIES… even when it means disappointing others.

And in that process…
I found something I had never truly known before:

SELF-WORTH.

Not the kind that comes from achievement—
but the kind that comes from within.

And let me tell you…
that kind of WORTH is hard-earned.
But it is unshakeable.

So today, NOW, I ask:

What would happen…
if we, as a collective…
declared our independence?

Not from countries.
But from conditioning.

Independence from fear.
From silence.
From inherited beliefs that no longer serve HUMANITY.

Because the TRUTH is—
many of the systems we live within today
were built without the full voice of HUMANITY at the table.

And we are seeing the consequences of that.

Disconnection.
Burnout.
Division.

But here is the good news:

We are not powerless.

There is a quiet movement happening—
in classrooms…
in homes…
in communities…

People choosing COURAGE over comfort.
CONNECTION over competition.
LOVE over fear.

This is where Truth and ReconciliACTION begins.

Not in perfection.
But in PRESENCE.

Not in blame.
But in ACCOUNTABILITY.

Not in shame.
But in COMPASSION—for ourselves and for each other.

Because RECONCILIACTION is not just something that happens between groups—
it begins within each of us.

When we tell the TRUTH about our own lives.
When we examine what we've inherited.
When we ACKNOWLEDGE THE LAND we stand on…
and the histories that live within it.
When we choose to heal… instead of pass pain forward.

That is how HUMANITY moves forward.

Not all at once.
But one person…
one family…
one COMMUNITY at a time.

So today, I state that I am not someone who has it all figured out—
but someone who has chosen a different path.

A path of SOFTNESS in a hard world.
A path of COURAGE in the face of fear.
A path of LOVE… even when it would be easier to close my HEART.

And I believe—deeply—
that if enough of us choose this path…

We don't just change our own LIVES.

We help heal HUMANITY.

So, this is my invitation to anyone who chooses COURAGE over COMFORT:

Tell the TRUTH.
Choose RESPONSIBILITY over denial.
Lead with your HEART.

And together…
let's create a new kind of independence—

One rooted in CONNECTION, COMPASSION,
and the COURAGE to become fully HUMAN.

I live here as a settler on Treaty 7 territory—
the traditional lands of the Blackfoot Confederacy,
the Tsuut'ina Nation,
and the Stoney Nakoda Nations.

But acknowledgement… is only the beginning.

If we are serious about Truth and ReconciliACTION,
we must ask ourselves:

What does it mean to live here—responsibly?

It means listening—deeply—to Indigenous voices.
It means learning the histories that were not taught to us.
It means supporting Indigenous communities—not just in words,
but in action, relationships, and resources.

It means asking:
How do I show up differently… today?

Because RECONCILIATION is not a statement—
it is a practice.

It lives in our choices.
In our classrooms.
In our conversations.
In how we raise our CHILDREN.
In how we use our VOICES.

As I conclude, I invite these words to become more than reflection—let these words become a commitment to show up differently, starting NOW.

Let this LAND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT not be the end of something—
but the beginning.

A beginning of AWARENESS.
A beginning of RESPONSIBILITY.
A beginning of ACTION.

Because when we honour the LAND…
and the people who have cared for it since time immemorial…

We take one step closer
to healing—not just ourselves—
but HUMANITY.

-Simone Homeniuk, 30 Year Teacher

HERSTORY + HISTORY = HUMANITY

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